

# CRAM SHEET

## Channel Theory – Concept, Nomenclature, Flow of Qi

12 Meridians · 3 Circuits · Quiz 1 Ready

### 12 MERIDIANS

6 Yin + 6 Yang  
3 Hand + 3 Foot each

### 3 CIRCUITS

Outer / Inner / Middle  
4 meridians each

### 15 COLLATERALS

12 primary + Du + Ren  
+ Spleen's Great Luo

#### How to use this

This is the foundation everything else builds on – know it cold before Week 2.  
The circulation rule (chest-hand-head-foot-chest) is the single most tested fact in the course.  
Draw each circuit by hand, more than once – Dr. Zhang's own studying advice.

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## What Is a Channel?

'Channels' (Jing-Luo) is the umbrella term covering BOTH Meridians (Jing, the primary pathways - like a river) AND Collaterals (Luo, the branches - smaller networks connecting meridians to tissues and organs).

### The full system:

- 12 Primary Meridians (Jing) - the main rivers
- 15 Collaterals (Luo) - 12 from each primary meridian's own Luo-connecting point, plus the Luo of Du Mai, Ren Mai, and the Spleen's Great Luo (Dabao)
- 12 Divergent Meridians - branch from the primary meridians, distribute on chest/abdomen/head, deepen the Zang-Fu relationship (detail taught later in the course)
- 12 Muscle (Sinew) Regions - distribution of the primary meridians into the muscular system
- 12 Cutaneous Regions - the most superficial layer, where channel Qi reflects on the skin
- 8 Extraordinary Vessels - Du, Ren, Chong, Dai, Yinwei, Yangwei, Yingqiao, Yangqiao; act as reservoirs of Qi and Blood, closely connected to the Kidney, regulating the primary meridians as needed (detail taught later)

## Zang-Fu Organs

### Zang (Yin) - 6 organs

- Lung (LU)
- Spleen (SP)
- Heart (HT)
- Liver (LR)
- Kidney (KI)
- Pericardium (PC)

### Fu (Yang) - 6 organs

- Large Intestine (LI)
- Stomach (ST)
- Small Intestine (SI)
- Bladder (BL)
- Gallbladder (GB)
- San Jiao (SJ)

## 3-Part Nomenclature

1. Hand or Foot (location of the pathway)
2. Yin or Yang (nature / medial-lateral surface)
3. Zang or Fu (pertaining organ)

*e.g. 'Lung Meridian of Hand-Taiyin', 'Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming'*

## The 12 Primary Meridians

| Ab | Name                     | Classification | Direction     | Circuit           |
|----|--------------------------|----------------|---------------|-------------------|
| LU | Lung                     | Hand Taiyin    | Chest -> Hand | Outer (Anterior)  |
| LI | Large Intestine          | Hand Yangming  | Hand -> Head  | Outer (Anterior)  |
| ST | Stomach                  | Foot Yangming  | Head -> Foot  | Outer (Anterior)  |
| SP | Spleen                   | Foot Taiyin    | Foot -> Chest | Outer (Anterior)  |
| HT | Heart                    | Hand Shaoyin   | Chest -> Hand | Inner (Posterior) |
| SI | Small Intestine          | Hand Taiyang   | Hand -> Head  | Inner (Posterior) |
| BL | Bladder                  | Foot Taiyang   | Head -> Foot  | Inner (Posterior) |
| KI | Kidney                   | Foot Shaoyin   | Foot -> Chest | Inner (Posterior) |
| PC | Pericardium              | Hand Jueyin    | Chest -> Hand | Middle            |
| SJ | San Jiao (Triple Burner) | Hand Shaoyang  | Hand -> Head  | Middle            |
| GB | Gallbladder              | Foot Shaoyang  | Head -> Foot  | Middle            |
| LR | Liver                    | Foot Jueyin    | Foot -> Chest | Middle            |

## The 3 Circuits

### Outer Circuit (Anterior)

Taiyin / Yangming

LU (chest->hand) -> LI (hand->head) -> ST (head->foot) -> SP (foot->chest)

### Inner Circuit (Posterior)

Shaoyin / Taiyang

HT (chest->hand) -> SI (hand->head) -> BL (head->foot) -> KI (foot->chest)

### Middle Circuit (Middle/Lateral)

Jueyin / Shaoyang

PC (chest->hand) -> SJ (hand->head) -> GB (head->foot) -> LR (foot->chest)

## Direction of Qi Flow

Yin meridians of the HAND  
 Yang meridians of the HAND  
 Yang meridians of the FOOT  
 Yin meridians of the FOOT

Chest -> Hand  
 Hand -> Head  
 Head -> Foot  
 Foot -> Chest/Abdomen

## Where Meridians Meet

**Hand Yin meets Hand Yang at the FINGERS**

*e.g. LU7's branch meets LI1 at the index finger*

**Hand Yang meets Foot Yang at the FACE**

*e.g. LI ends at LI20, ST begins there*

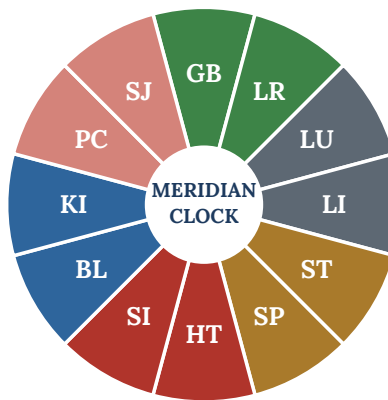
**Foot Yang meets Foot Yin at the TOES**

*e.g. ST ends at ST45, SP begins at SP1*

**Foot Yin meets Hand Yin at the CHEST**

*completes the full 12-channel loop back to the next circuit*

## Meridian Clock (24 hr)



Metal (LU/LI) · Earth (ST/SP) · Fire (HT/SI) · Water (BL/KI) · Min. Fire (PC/SJ) · Wood (GB/LR)

## 3 Functions of Meridians

### Transporting

Transport Qi and Blood to nourish the organs, skin, muscles, tendons, and bones; keep Yin-Yang in harmony throughout the body.

### Resisting (Defending)

Defend the body against disease - meridians help resist pathogens and reflect symptoms/signs when something is wrong.

### Treatment

Transmit needling sensation and regulate deficiency and excess conditions - the basis for using meridians and points clinically.

## Rapid Recall — Channel Theory

Read this one last, on the way in

### The “ONLY” List

Term for the whole system (meridians + collaterals)

Number of Zang (Yin) organs

Number of Fu (Yang) organs

Total collaterals (12 primary + Du + Ren + Spleen's Great Luo)

Circuit containing HT, SI, BL, KI

Circuit containing PC, SJ, GB, LR

**Channels**

**6**

**6**

**15**

**Inner (Posterior)**

**Middle**

### Exam Traps

- 'Meridians' means the 12 Primary Meridians specifically. 'Channels' is the whole system - meridians AND collaterals.
- The location-based names (Taiyin/Yangming = anterior, etc.) describe medial/lateral POSITION on the limb, not organ function - don't conflate the two.
- Direction of flow depends on BOTH hand/foot AND yin/yang together - all four combinations are different (chest->hand, hand->head, head->foot, foot->chest).
- The Middle Circuit's Yang channel is San Jiao (Triple Burner/Trample Burner), not to be confused with Small Intestine.